

LABLAB

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of one species of deciduous, woody-stemmed, twining climber, grown for its attractive, pealike flowers (in tropics is grown for green manure and animal feed, and for its edible pods and seeds). Often raised as an annual. Frost tender. Grow in sun and in any well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring.
L. *purpureus*, syn. *Dolichos lablab*, *D. purpureus* (Australian pea, Hyacinth bean, Lablab), illus. p.203.

+ LABURNOCYTISUS

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Deciduous tree, grown for its flowers. A graft hybrid between *Laburnum anagyroides* and *Cytisus purpureus*. Fully hardy. Requires full sun; grows in any but waterlogged soil. Propagate by grafting on laburnum in late summer.
+ **L. ‘Adamii’**. Deciduous, spreading tree. H 25ft (8m), S 20ft (6m). In late spring and early summer, bears 3 types of blooms: yellow, laburnum flowers; purple, cytiscus flowers; and laburnumlike, yellow and pinkish-purple flowers. Leaves, with 3 ovate leaflets, are dark green. Z5–7

LABURNUM

PAPILIONACEAE/LEGUMINOSAE

Genus of deciduous trees, grown for their profuse, pendent flower clusters in spring and summer. Fully hardy. Does best in full sun; grows in any but waterlogged soil. Seeds are very poisonous. Propagate species by seed in fall, hybrids by budding in summer. ☉ All parts are highly toxic if ingested.

L. *alpinum* illus. p.89.
L. *anagyroides*, syn. *L. vulgare* (Common laburnum, Golden chain). Deciduous, spreading tree. H and S 25ft (8m). Leaves have 3 ovate leaflets and are gray-green. Short, pendent, dense clusters of large, pealike, yellow flowers are borne in late spring and early summer. Z5–7
L. *vulgare*. See *L. anagyroides*.
L. x *watereri* ‘Vossii’ (Voss’s laburnum) illus. p.84.

LACHENALIA

ASPARAGACEAE

Genus of winter- and spring-flowering bulbs with tubular or bell-shaped flowers; some have attractively mottled leaves. Useful as pot plants and in open borders. Half hardy. Requires light, well-drained soil and a sunny site. Plant in early fall; dry off in summer when foliage has died down. Propagate in fall by seed or freely produced offsets.
L. *aloides*, syn. *L. tricolor*, *L. ‘Tricolor’*. Winter- and spring-flowering bulb. H 6–11in (15–28cm), S 2in (5cm). Has 2 strap-shaped, semierect, basal, purple-spotted, green leaves. Produces a spike of 10–20 pendent flowers, each 1¼in (3cm)

long with a yellow tube shading to red at the apex and with flared, green tips. Z10–11
‘Nelsonii’ (syn. *L. ‘Nelsonii’*) illus. p.429.
var. *quadricolor* see *L. quadricolor*.
L. *angustifolia*. See *L. contaminata*.
L. *contaminata*, syn. *L. angustifolia*. Winter- and spring-flowering bulb. H 2½–10in (6–25cm), S 2in (5cm). Has narrowly strap-shaped, semierect leaves in a basal cluster. Bears a spike of bell-shaped, white flowers, ¼in (0.5cm) long, suffused and tipped with red and green. Z10–11
L. *glauцина*. See *L. orchioides* var. *glauцина*.
L. *mutabilis*. Winter- to spring-flowering bulb. H 4–18in (10–45cm), S 2in (5cm). Has 1 or 2 strap-shaped, semierect, basal leaves. Stem bears a loose spike of up to 25 tubular, flowers, ½in (1cm) long, purple or lilac in bud, opening to reddish-brown-tipped petals with a green tube base. Z10–11
L. ‘Nelsonii’. See *L. aloides* ‘Nelsonii’.
L. *orchioides*. Winter- and spring-flowering bulb. H 6–16in (15–40cm), S 2in (5cm). Has 2 strap-shaped, semierect, basal, green leaves, sometimes spotted blackish- or purple-brown. Stem produces a dense spike of fragrant, semierect, tubular, white flowers, ½in (1cm) long, blue-tinged and tipped with green. Z10–11
var. *glauцина* (syn. *L. glauцина*) flowers in late winter and early spring. H to 12in (30cm), S 2–3in (5–8cm). Leaves are usually spotted purple. Bears a spike of fragrant, whitish-blue or pale lilac flowers.
L. *quadricolor*, syn. *L. aloides* var. *quadricolor*, illus. p.429.
L. *rubida*. Winter-flowering bulb. H 2½–10in (6–25cm), S 2in (5cm). Has 2 semierect, basal, strap-shaped, purple-spotted, green leaves. Bears a loose spike of pendent, tubular, red flowers, ¾–1¼in (2–3cm) long, shading to yellow at tips. Z10–11
L. *tricolor*. See *L. aloides*.
L. ‘Tricolor’. See *L. aloides*.

Lactuca *alpina*. See *Cicerbita alpina*.
Lactuca *bourgaei*. See *Cicerbita bourgaei*.

LAELIA

ORCHIDACEAE

See also ORCHIDS.
L. *anceps* (illus. p.466). Evergreen, epiphytic orchid for a cool greenhouse. H 10in (25cm). Lilac-pink flowers, 2½in (6cm) across, each with a deep mauve lip, are borne in tall spikes in fall. Has ovate, rigid leaves, 4–6in (10–15cm) long. Needs partial shade in summer.
L. *cinnabarina*. See *Cattleya cinnabarina*.

x **Laeliocattleya Rojo gx ‘Mont Millais’**. See x *Cattlianthe* Rojo gx ‘Mont Millais’.

LAGERSTROEMIA

LYTHRACEAE

Genus of deciduous or evergreen, summer-flowering shrubs and trees, grown for their flowers. Half hardy, or frost hardy in areas with hot summers where wood can ripen fully. Prefers fertile, well-drained soil and full light. Water potted specimens liberally when in full growth, less at other times. To maintain as shrubs, cut back

hard the previous season’s stems each spring. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer.
L. *indica* (Crepe myrtle; illus. p.86). Deciduous, rounded tree or large shrub. H and S 25ft (8m). Bears trusses of flowers with strongly waved, pink, white, or purple petals in summer and early fall. Z9–11
‘Cedar Red’ has red-flushed young growth and deep vibrant red flowers.
RHAPSODY IN PINK (‘Whit VIII’) has dark red young growth and soft pink flowers.
‘Rosea’ has deep rose-pink flowers.
‘Seminole’ is compact and bears mid-pink flowers.

LAGUNARIA

MALVACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen tree, grown for its flowers in summer–fall and its overall appearance. Frost tender. Prefers fertile, well-drained soil and full light. Water potted plants liberally when in full summer growth, moderately at other times. Pruning is tolerated if required. Propagate by seed in spring or by semiripe cuttings in summer. Under cover, red spider mite may be troublesome. ☉ Contact with the seeds may irritate skin.
L. *pateronii* (Norfolk Island hibiscus, Queensland pyramidal tree). Fast-growing, evergreen, upright tree, pyramidal when young. H to 50ft (15m), S 25–40ft (8–12m). Ovate, rough leaves are matte-green above, whitish-green beneath. Bears hibiscuslike, rose-pink flowers, 2in (5cm) across, in summer. Z10–11 (min. 37–41°F/3–5°C)

LAGURUS

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.
L. *ovatus* (Hare’s tail grass) illus. p.284.

LAMARCKIA

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.
L. *aurea* (Golden top). Tuft-forming, annual grass. H 12in (30cm), S 10in (25cm). Wiry stems have scattered, flat, twisted, broadly linear, pale green leaves. From mid-spring to summer, bears erect, dense, one-sided panicles of golden-yellow or whitish-green spikelets. Needs sun. Z7–11

LAMIUM

Deadnettle

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of spring- or summer-flowering perennials, most of which are semi-evergreen, including a number of weeds; some species provide useful groundcover. Fully hardy. Prefers full or partial shade and moist but well-drained soil. Resents excessive winter wet. Propagate by stem-tip cuttings of non-flowering shoots in midsummer or by division in fall or early spring.
L. *galeobdolon* ‘Florentinum’, syn. *L.g.* ‘Variegatum’. Semievergreen, carpeting perennial. H to 1ft (30cm), S indefinite. Ovate, mid-green leaves are marked with silver. Racemes of tubular,

2-lipped, lemon-yellow flowers are borne in summer. **‘Variegatum’** see *L.g.* ‘Florentinum’.
L. *maculatum*. Semievergreen, mat-forming perennial. H 8in (20cm), S 3ft (1m). Has mauve-tinged, often pink-flushed, leaves with central, silvery stripes. Clusters of hooded, mauve-pink flowers are borne in mid-spring. Z6–10. **‘Album’** illus. p.255.
‘Aureum’ (syn. *L.m.* ‘Gold Leaf’), H 8in (20cm), S 2ft (60cm), Has ovate, yellow leaves with paler white centers. Whorls of hooded, pink flowers are borne on short stems in summer. **‘Beacon Silver’** has mauve-tinged, silver leaves, sometimes with narrow, green margins, and clear pale pink flowers. **‘Gold Leaf’** see *L.m.* ‘Aureum’. **‘White Nancy’** illus. p.254.
L. *orvala* illus. p.260. **f. *albiflorum*** see *L.m.* ‘Album’. **‘Album’** (syn. *L.m.* *f. albiflorum*) is a clump-forming perennial. H and S 1ft (30cm). Forms a mound of toothed, softly hairy, dark green leaves. Spikes of whorled, white flowers open in late spring to summer. Z6–10

LAMPRANTHUS

AIZOACEAE

Genus of creeping, bushy, perennial succulents and subshrubs with daisylike flowers. Becomes woody after several years, when is best replenished. Plants are good for summer bedding, particularly in arid conditions. Leaves redden in strong sun. Frost tender. Requires full sun and very well-drained soil. Propagate by seed or stem cuttings in spring or fall.
L. *aurantiacus*. See *L. glaucoides*.
L. *deltoides*. See *Oscularia deltoides*.
L. *glaucoides*, syn. *L. aurantiacus*, illus. p.496.
L. *haworthii*. Erect to creeping, perennial succulent. H to 20in (50cm), S indefinite. Blue-gray leaves are cylindrical and 2in (5cm) long. In spring, bears abundant, daisylike, cerise flowers, 3in (7cm) across, that only open in sun. Z10–11 (min. 36°F/2°C)
L. *roseus*, syn. *Mesembryanthemum multiradiatum*. Creeping, perennial succulent. H to 20in (50cm), S indefinite. Has solid, 3-angled, mid- to glaucous green leaves, 2in (5cm) long. Daisylike, dark rose-red flowers, 1½in (4cm) across, open only in sun from spring to fall. Z10–11 (min. 36°F/2°C)
L. *spectabilis* illus. p.484.

LAMPROCAPNOS

PAPAVERACEAE

Genus of one species of perennial, previously included in the genus *Dicentra*, grown for its attractive sprays of pendent flowers. Fully hardy. Prefers moist but well-drained, humus-rich soil in partial shade. Propagate by seed in spring, or division in early spring or fall after leaves have died down.
L. *spectabilis*, syn. *Dicentra spectabilis*, illus. p.223. **‘Alba’** (syn. *Dicentra spectabilis* ‘Alba’) illus. p.223.

LANTANA

VERBENACEAE

Genus of evergreen perennials and shrubs, grown for their flowers. Frost tender.